

From Paper to Predictive AI

The ROI of Automated Site
Logging in Civil Engineering

2026 Maturity Model & ROI Analysis

The documentation burden is the largest hidden cost

Documentation tasks consume 35-40% of non-productive labor in construction — the single largest operational inefficiency in the industry. For a contractor running typical 4.5% net margins, documentation overhead can represent 60-100% of annual profit.

1

Time drain

Paper daily reports take 30-45 minutes per superintendent per day. Over a year, that's 130-195 hours per person spent writing, not supervising.

2

Compliance exposure

Documentation violations account for 34% of all OSHA construction safety citations. Missing records mean fines up to \$16,131 per violation.

3

Dispute vulnerability

Without timestamped, searchable records, contractors lose the ability to defend claims. Handwritten logs in a trailer rarely survive legal scrutiny.

35%

of a project manager's
work week is consumed
by documentation tasks
— not managing
the project.

Source: AGC 2025
Productivity Report

The Site Logging Maturity Model

Four stages from manual paper trails to AI-driven predictive safety:



Most Brazilian contractors operate at Level 1-2. BaceTech enables the leap to Level 4.

4.2x

median first-year ROI reported by contractors who adopted automated documentation.

Source: AGC Member Survey 2025

The ROI of automated site logging

Metric	Manual (Paper/Excel)	Automated (AI)	Impact
Daily report time	30-45 min/day	5-8 min/day	82% reduction
Annual hours/superintendent	130-195 hours	22-35 hours	160+ hours recovered
Cost per superintendent/year	\$11,000-\$16,500	\$1,870-\$2,975	\$9,000+ saved
Data searchability	None (paper) or limited	Full-text + AI indexed	Audit-ready in seconds
Dispute defense	Handwritten, no metadata	Timestamped, geotagged	Legally defensible

"Paper daily reports take 30 to 45 minutes at the end of the day. Digital daily reporting with voice-to-text takes 5 to 10 minutes spread throughout the day. If those records exist in a searchable, timestamped digital format, the penalty reduction argument is straightforward."

— BuildLog, Digital Construction Documentation ROI Analysis 2026

Bottom line: A single superintendent saves \$620-\$1,090/month in recovered productive time — a 6x to 11x return on tool cost.

45→8
min

daily report creation
time reduced with
mobile-first capture.

Source: Procore 2024
Field Productivity Data

Recommended Actions

1

Start with daily reports

The highest-volume, lowest-complexity document. Switch from paper to mobile capture in week 1. Target: 5-8 min/day.

2

Add photo + voice capture

Eliminate typing on site. Voice-to-text and photo-with-AI-analysis reduce friction to near zero for field crews.

3

Measure before and after

Track time per report, data completeness, and incident response time. The ROI is visible within 30 days.

4

Build institutional memory

Every logged incident becomes searchable knowledge. After 90 days, AI can identify patterns humans miss.

Skip levels. Go from paper to AI-predictive in 30 days.

BaceTech is purpose-built for the Level 1-to-Level 4 leap:

- Photo or voice capture replaces paper logs — under 60 seconds
- AI auto-generates descriptions, identifies causes, references norms
- Every incident is timestamped, geotagged, and audit-ready
- Pattern detection runs continuously across all projects
- Institutional memory grows with every capture

The platform delivers the ROI documented in this report from day one — no complex implementation, no training overhead. Field crews capture; AI does the rest.

Sources: AGC 2025 Productivity Report; McKinsey 2024; Procore 2024; BuildLog 2026; OSHA 2025; ENR.

BaceTech

**Start your 30-day
free evaluation**

app.bace-tech.fr

No credit card required